
**CONTACT
INFORMATION**

Department of Economics
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Citizenship: Chilean

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, UCLA (2023 – present)

Thesis Chair: Professor [Saki Bigio](#).

Master of Arts in Economics, Universidad de Chile (2023).

Thesis Chair: Professor [Eduardo Engel](#).

Bachelor of Arts in Economics, Universidad de Chile (2018).

**RESEARCH
INTERESTS**

Macroeconomics, Macro-Finance, Asset Pricing, and Computational Economics.

**WORKING
PAPERS**

[“Countercyclical Earning Risk in Large Recessions: Consumption Dynamics and Welfare Losses”](#) (with [Bernardo Candia](#), 2023).

Abstract: Labor earnings shocks exhibit pro-cyclical skewness. We investigate how these cyclical risks account for the U.S. Great Recession’s consumption dynamics and assess to what extent welfare losses could be exacerbated. By building a model of incomplete markets with idiosyncratic unemployment and efficiency risk correlated with aggregate shocks, we find three main differences compared to a model with only cyclical unemployment. First, consumption’s initial decline is 0.5 percentage points larger, and its recovery is significantly slower. Second, aggregate welfare losses are more prominent in terms of lifetime consumption: 4.1% versus 3.1%. Third, the cross-sectional distribution of welfare losses has a thicker and longer right tail, meaning a non-negligible fraction of households suffer major losses.

**WORK IN
PROGRESS**

“Diagnostic Expectations and Endogenous Risk.”

Abstract: This paper integrates diagnostic expectations, modeled as a sentiment state variable, into the macro-finance model of Brunnermeier and Sannikov (2014). We argue that diagnostic expectations amplify both the probability and the severity of financial crises via two complementary mechanisms: (i) over-accumulation of capital by leveraged experts during booms, which intensifies fire sales to less productive households when experts’ optimistic beliefs are disappointed; and (ii) underestimation of endogenous risk (a second-moment effect of a first-moment bias), as experts do not internalize that sentiment responds to shocks, which leads them to lever up excessively and makes the economy prone to volatility spikes, a belief-driven version of the volatility paradox. Together, these mechanisms offer a way to reconcile the Minskian view of financial crises with the stabilizing effect of sentiment in Maxted (2024).

“Optimal Taxation, Incomplete Markets, and Aggregate Shocks.”

Abstract: We study how labor and capital income taxes should respond to the business cycle in an incomplete-markets economy with aggregate shocks and uninsurable idiosyncratic productivity risk, calibrated to match the empirical distribution of wealth. Tax rates are functions of aggregate productivity and the wealth distribution, with tax revenue rebated as lump-sum transfers. We parameterize the tax rates with neural networks trained to maximize social welfare under different degrees of wealth inequality aversion. We quantify the insurance and redistribution the government provides, the distortions it creates, and how this trade-off varies over the business cycle and with wealth inequality.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	Pre-doctoral fellow at Universidad de los Andes, Chile (2019 – 2023). - Research Assistant for Professor Álvaro García-Marín (2019 – 2023). Working paper: “Cities, Heterogeneous Firms, and Trade.” R&R at the <i>Quarterly Journal of Economics</i>. - Research Assistant for Professor Juan Pablo Xandri (2022 – 2023). Work in progress: “Directed Search over Poisson Point Processes.”
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	Graduate Teaching Assistant, Ph.D. in Economics, UCLA (Winter 2026): - Macroeconomic Theory 202B. Professor: Pierre-Olivier Weill. Lecturer, Universidad de los Andes, Chile (2019 – 2023): - Master’s level: Microeconomic Theory. - Undergraduate: Macroeconomics, Probability Theory, and Industrial Organization. Lecturer, M.A. in Economics, Universidad de Chile (2019 – 2023): - Workshop: MATLAB and Introduction to Dynamic Programming. Graduate Teaching Assistant, M.A. in Economics, Universidad de Chile (2017 – 2018): - Macroeconomics I and II, Econometrics and Time Series Analysis.
HONORS AND AWARDS	- Maximum Distinction, Micro comprehensive exam, M.A. in Economics, U. de Chile. - National Master’s Scholarship, Chilean National Research Agency (ANID). - Undergraduate: Circle of Excellence (top 5%), U. de Chile (2015, 2016 and 2017). - Undergraduate: Honor Roll (top 1%), U. de Chile (2013 and 2014).
COMPUTER SKILLS	- MATLAB: C-MEX, Parallel Computing and Deep Learning Toolboxes, and computing at Chile’s National Laboratory for High Performance Computing (NLHPC). - JULIA: parallel and GPU computing (CUDA.jl). - L^AT_EX.
LANGUAGES	Spanish (native), English (fluent).
HOBBIES	Weightlifting and soccer (goalkeeper).